

CAMP DARDEN

August 7-9, 2026

The annual first-year weekend: bonfires, lawn games, river tubing, hiking, and your first real crew at Darden.

Bonfires

Games

Music

FY Bonding

WHY CAMP DARDEN

Start Darden with a story.

Before cases, cold calls, and recruiting take over, Camp Darden brings the class together for a weekend that feels nothing like school and everything like community. Come for the bonfire. Leave with friends.



Buy your tickets [now](#)



WHAT TO EXPECT

A weekend built for the class.

Camp Darden is intentionally simple: get outside, meet people, and create the kind of inside jokes that make the first year feel smaller.

- **Friday night bonfire**

Dinner, drinks, music, games, and the first big hangout with classmates.

- **Saturday adventure**

Optional hike and river tubing, plus lawn games and time to relax at camp.

- **Low-pressure bonding**

Come with friends or show up solo. The whole point is to make it easy to meet people.

- **Classic DOC energy**

Outdoorsy enough to feel like an escape. Social enough to feel like the official kickoff.

The vibe:

Summer camp energy, Darden community, and zero case preparation required.



August 7-9, 2026 | New Castle, VA

Friday - 8/07

Convoy, river tubing, dinner, and games

- **11:30 AM** DOC-led convoy from Darden
- **2:00 PM** Arrive at camp and unpack
- **3:30 PM** River tubing
- **7:30 PM** Dinner
- **9:00 PM** Games & new friends

Saturday - 8/08

Hike, lunch, tubing, water slide, games, dinner, and sendoff party

- **8:30 AM** Breakfast
- **10:00 AM** Hike
- **1:00 PM** Return to camp
- **1:30 PM** Lunch
- **2:15 PM** Water slide, river tubing, & games
- **7:00 PM** Dinner
- **8:30 PM+** Bonfire, games, send off party

Sunday - 8/09

Pack up, clean up, and head back to Charlottesville

- **9:00-10:30 AM** Cleanup, checkout, and depart

LEARN MORE